# ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

## SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(d)** rhyme and sound alike | Sound play. |
| 2 | **(a)** Custard's looks and his nature | Contrast. |
| 3 | **(b)** sword | Weapon. |
| 4 | **(d)** invented words for humour | Playful language. |
| 5 | **(a)** an amused observer | Third person. |
| 6 | **(a)** coward | Derived. |
| 7 | **(b)** the timid dragon is the real hero | Reversal. |
| 8 | **(d)** humorous simile | As ... as. |
| 9 | **(d)** tells a story | Narrative. |
| 10 | **(a)** create comedy | Humour. |

## SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | They rhyme and sound silly (1) like Ink, Blink, Mustard and Custard (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | He saves everyone (1) yet still wants a safe cage (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | As brave and loving (1) with a household of strange pets (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | It is absurd and funny (1) because bears in a barrel are not brave (1). | 1+1 |

## SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Funny names (1). Exaggerated boasts (1). Comic twist at the end (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Comparisons (1). Pirate's weapons (1). Dragon's looks (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | The pets said that they were brave (1). Tense backshift (1). Pronoun change (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Custard is fierce-looking and timid (1). Others boast of bravery (1). In danger they flee while he fights (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Danger over (1). Heroes praised (1). Funny final twist (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Although Custard was afraid, he fought the pirate (1). 'Although' shows contrast (1). Complex sentence (1). | 1+1+1 |

## SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Names (1). Exaggeration (1). Irony (1). Rhyme (1). Twist (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Definition (1). Examples (1). Effect (1). Humour (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Boasters (1). Custard (1). Pirate scene (1). Outcome (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Greeting (1). Custard (1). Meaning (1). Examples (1). Closing (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(d)** He is a hero but unchanged | Irony. |
| 2 | **(d)** invented words and absurd humour | Absurd. |
| 3 | **(b)** lack of confidence | Timidity. |
| 4 | **(d)** a comic villain | Stock villain. |
| 5 | **(c)** boasting | Brag. |
| 6 | **(c)** acts bravely when needed | Courage. |
| 7 | **(b)** serious tragedy | It is a comedy. |
| 8 | **(b)** doing the right thing despite fear | Definition. |
| 9 | **(d)** a light-hearted tale | Fun. |
| 10 | **(c)** humour | Indirect. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | It is bouncy and quick (1) matching the comic tone (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | It has a dragon, a pirate and a girl (1) with a simple moral and happy end (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Danger tests each character (1) and reveals who is truly brave (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | To make their later cowardice funnier (1) and to show boasting is empty (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Couplets (1). Bounce (1). Made-up words (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Treats small events with grand style (1). Comic effect (1). Seen in comparisons (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | The timid dragon hid (1). Do not boast of bravery (1). Both words used correctly (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** A dragon is expected to be fierce (1). Custard is timid (1). The tale shows him as brave in deed (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Simple story (1). Rhyme (1). Clear moral (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** bravery (1). fear (1). boast (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Theme (1). Humour (1). Language (1). Rhythm (1). Evaluation (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Headline (1). Intro (1). Details (1). Quotes (1). Closing (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Both humorous (1). Narrative vs instruction (1). Irony in both (1). Rhyme (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Names (1). Sound pairs (1). Invented words (1). Effect (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

# ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

## SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** The Dragon Who Saved the Day | Fits. |
| 2 | **(d)** they were chosen for sound and humour | Playful. |
| 3 | **(c)** Belinda cried out for help. | Reporting an exclamation. |
| 4 | **(c)** comic and surprising | Surprise. |
| 5 | **(b)** couplets (aabb) | Pairs. |
| 6 | **(c)** The pirate was swallowed by Custard. | Past passive. |
| 7 | **(a)** children and adults | Broad appeal. |
| 8 | **(c)** words are not equal to deeds | Message. |
| 9 | **(c)** quickly | Modifies verb. |
| 10 | **(d)** gentle irony | Irony. |

## SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | He is the threat (1) that tests the heroes (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Custard looks fierce but is timid (1) and the 'brave' pets run away (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Courage can exist in a fearful heart (1) and is shown in action (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | It is funny and rhythmic (1) and its message is simple (1). | 1+1 |

## SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Boasters are untrustworthy (1). The pets ran away (1). Real deeds count (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Boastful talk (1). Quiet deed (1). Humility (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | It means to show cowardice (1). The pets ran away (1). It fits their behaviour (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** A little white house with tiny pets (1). Contrasts with a dragon and a pirate (1). Small and large clash (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | He feels insecure (1). He prefers safety (1). He is gentle (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** 'The Dragon Who Wanted a Cage' (1). It highlights the irony (1). It is catchy (1). | 1+1+1 |

## SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Opening (1). Pets (1). Pirate (1). Climax (1). Ending (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Format (1). Pets' apology (1). Custard's reply (1). Cage (1). End (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Characters (1). Setting (1). Dialogue (1). Action (1). Ending (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Looks vs nature (1). Boast vs deed (1). Ending (1). Message (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.